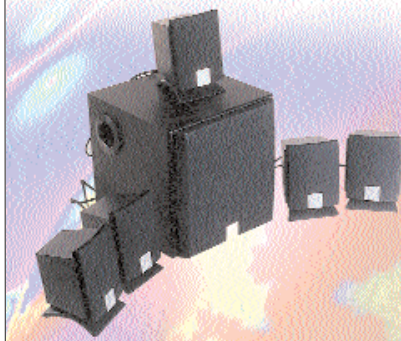


Sound's expensive

This speaker system supports 5.1 Dolby Digital surround sound. So if you have a DVD ROM drive and a Dolby digital compliant soundcard or amplifier, you can have true-to-life theatre-like experience right in your home. The set is good for playing deep punchy bass and for listening to tracks with rhythm. However, it is very highly priced.

Creative Inspire 5.1 5300



SPECIFICATIONS

Five satellites, one sub speaker; power rating of 6 Watt per satellite (five channels); 18 Watt subwoofer

verdict

B -

Creative Inspire 5.1 5300

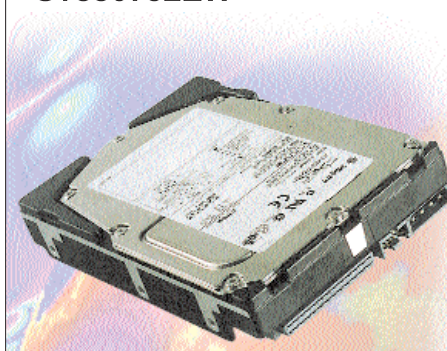
Performance	▲▲▲▲▲
Build Quality	▲▲▲▲▲
Value for Money	▲▲▲▲▲
Features	▲▲▲▲▲
OVERALL	▲▲▲▲▲

Price: Rs 31,655
Contact: Compuage Infocom Ltd
Phone: 022-8305500
Fax: 022-8238619
E-mail: info@compuageindia.com
Web site: www.compuageindia.com

Pro performance

This 15,000-rpm Ultra160 SCSI drive screams performance. Its 8 MB cache makes it suitable for applications involving frequent and continuous access to data, as in file servers. In SiSoft Sandra the average access time recorded was a mere 3 ms. If performance is what you seek and you work with applications that require swapping of huge files, this one's for you.

Seagate Cheetah ST336752LW



SPECIFICATIONS

36.7 GB drive capacity; eight read/write heads; 15,000-rpm disc rotational speed; 8 MB buffer

Benchmarks:

SiSoft Sandra: Drive index: 41813, average access time: 3 ms
HDtch: CPU utilisation: 9.5 per cent, maximum read speed: 61.2 MBps, Maximum write speed: 44.5 MBps

verdict

A -

Seagate Cheetah ST3366752LW

Performance	▲▲▲▲▲
Build Quality	▲▲▲▲▲
Value for Money	▲▲▲▲▲
Features	▲▲▲▲▲
OVERALL	▲▲▲▲▲

+ Very fast
- Expensive
Price: Rs 38,175
Contact: ACI Infocom Ltd
Phone: 011-6831878/79
Fax no: 011-6831968
E-mail: sanjayv@aciinfo.com
Web site: www.aciinfo.com

Audigy, the prodigy

The Audigy offers true-to-life sound through EAX Advanced HD. It features an integrated FireWire port for speedy transfer of audio data between the card and other peripherals. The card fits into any available PCI slot and includes ports for front and rear out, line-in and line-out and a digital out. Sounds were accurately reproduced while playing VOB files and games.

Creative Audigy Platinum eX



SPECIFICATIONS

Midi features: Audio processor: Audigy, type: wavetable, Midi channels: 48
Digital audio features: Full duplex, maximum recording depth: 16-bit, maximum recording rate: 48 KHz, maximum playback depth: 24-bit, maximum playback rate: 96 KHz, signal to noise ratio: 100 dB
Benchmarks: Direct-sound3D CPU utilisation at 44.1 KHz, 16 bits and 32 voices: 6.1 per cent

verdict

B +

Creative Audigy Platinum eX

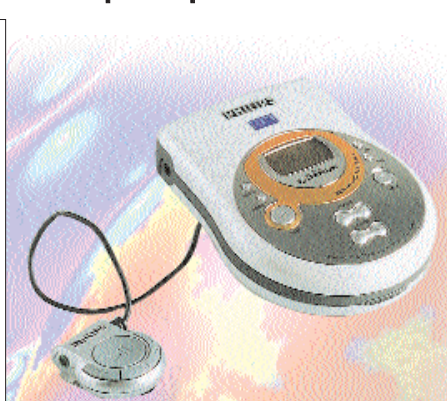
Performance	▲▲▲▲▲
Build Quality	▲▲▲▲▲
Value for Money	▲▲▲▲▲
Features	▲▲▲▲▲
OVERALL	▲▲▲▲▲

+ External Audigy drive
+ Good bundled software
- No on-board Dolby digital processor
Price: Rs 19,110
Contact: Compuage Infocom Ltd
Phone: 022-8305500; Fax: 022-8238619
E-mail: info@compuageindia.com
Web site: www.compuageindia.com

Smart and sleek

Successor to the Philips eXpanium CD MP3 player, it uses the smaller 8 cm CDs which can store around 190 MB of data. The player can read MP3s and AAC files at all bitrates, including VBR MP3s. It offers a 100 second skip buffer for MP3s—sufficient for regular use. The earphones delivered good bass reflex and crisp mids and highs.

Philips eXpanium EXP401



SPECIFICATIONS

1x AA battery, 100 seconds Magic ESP (Electronic Skip Protection) technology, dynamic bass boost, MP3 playback at 32 to 320 KBps including VBR, 8 cm CD compatibility (Audio CD, CD-R, CD-RW), headphones and AC/DC adapter included.

verdict

A -

Philips eXpanium EXP401

Performance	▲▲▲▲▲
Build Quality	▲▲▲▲▲
Value for Money	▲▲▲▲▲
Features	▲▲▲▲▲
OVERALL	▲▲▲▲▲

+ Small, easy to use
- Skips if roughly handled, no ID3 tag support
Price: Rs 9,990
Contact: Philips India Ltd
Phone: 022-6912333 Fax: 022-8259276
E-mail: gautam.dalal@philips.com
Web site: www.philipsindia.com